

ASIMOV'S THREE LAWS OF ROBOTICS

1. A ROBOT MAY NOT INJURE A HUMAN BEING OR, THROUGH INACTION, ALLOW A HUMAN BEING TO COME TO HARM.

2. A ROBOT MUST OBEY ORDERS GIVEN TO IT BY HUMAN BEINGS, EXCEPT WHERE SUCH ORDERS WOULD CONFLICT WITH THE FIRST LAW.

3. A ROBOT MUST PROTECT ITS OWN EXISTENCE AS LONG AS SUCH PROTECTION DOES NOT CONFLICT WITH THE FIRST OR SECOND LAW.

THE RULES OF ROBOTICS

Ethics is a boring subject taught in certain universities. But with robotics, it could be what prevents us from going extinct.

While there's plenty of excitement around the very idea of robots – man's ultimate creation, as many term them – there is also the prospect of danger. Some of these dangers, as envisioned in dystopian sci-fi flicks in which the robots have taken over control of the world from us, may seem rather exaggerated.

But then, as many scientists are acknowledging that we may not be able to understand the reasoning style of an artificially intelligent being, our fears may not be all paranoia. Some rules to govern the robots would be handy.